

# Tables for Reference

*Three sets of tables gather in one place what the chapters treat in sequence: the judgments, the resurrections, and the views this book weighs. Each row points to the chapter where the matter is argued from the text.*

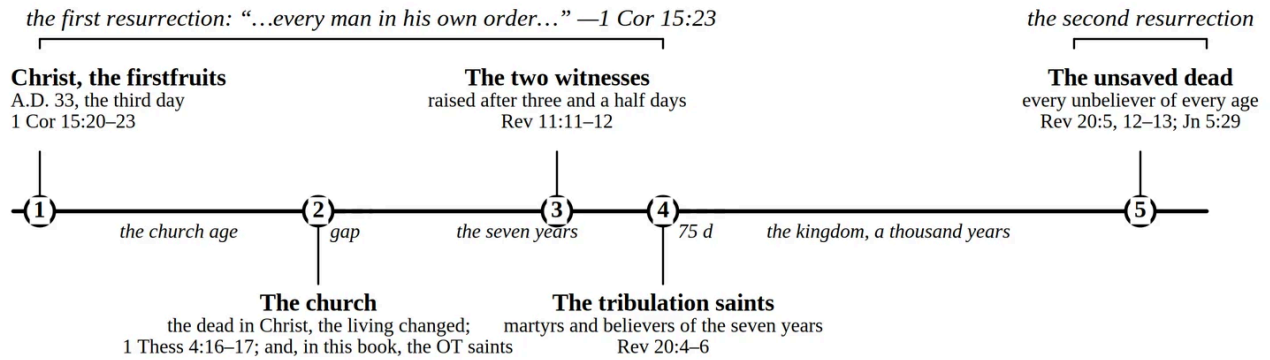
## The Judgments

| Judgment                                             | When                                                          | Who is judged                                                                              | Basis                                                                             | Outcome                                                                        | Scripture; Chapter                             |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The judgment seat of Christ (the bema)</b>        | In heaven, after the rapture, before the marriage of the Lamb | Believers of the church age (and, in this book, the Old Testament saints raised with them) | Works done after salvation, tested by fire; not salvation itself                  | Reward given or withheld; the believer is saved regardless                     | 2 Cor 5:10; 1 Cor 3:11–15; Rom 14:10; Ch. 3, 8 |
| <b>The judgment of Israel</b>                        | At the return, in the seventy-five days before the kingdom    | Jews who survive the tribulation in natural bodies                                         | Faith in the Messiah they have now seen                                           | Believers enter the land and the kingdom; rebels are purged and do not enter   | Ezek 20:33–38; Zech 12:10; Ch. 17              |
| <b>The judgment of the nations (sheep and goats)</b> | At the return, in the seventy-five days before the kingdom    | Gentiles who survive the tribulation in natural bodies                                     | Treatment of the King's brethren during the tribulation, as the evidence of faith | Sheep enter the kingdom in mortal bodies; goats go into everlasting punishment | Matt 25:31–46; Joel 3:2; Ch. 17                |
| <b>The great white throne</b>                        | After the thousand years and the final rebellion              | The unsaved dead of all ages, raised for judgment                                          | The books of works, and the book of life in which their names are not found       | The second death: the lake of fire, forever                                    | Rev 20:11–15; Ch. 19, 20                       |

## The Resurrections

*“But every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits; afterward they that are Christ’s at his coming” —1 Cor 15:23. The first resurrection is one harvest gathered in stages; the second is a single event a thousand years later (see Figure 7, below).*

| Stage                            | When                                                                           | Who is raised                                                                                 | Scripture; Chapter                               |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Christ, the firstfruits</b>   | A.D. 33, the third day                                                         | Christ alone, with the saints of Matthew 27:52–53 as a sign                                   | 1 Cor 15:20–23; Matt 27:52–53; Ch. 1             |
| <b>The church at the rapture</b> | Before the tribulation, at an hour no one knows                                | The dead in Christ, then the living changed; in this book, the Old Testament saints with them | 1 Thess 4:16–17; 1 Cor 15:51–52; Dan 12:2; Ch. 3 |
| <b>The two witnesses</b>         | Three and a half days after their death, in the second half of the tribulation | The two witnesses                                                                             | Rev 11:11–12; Ch. 10                             |
| <b>The tribulation saints</b>    | At the return, before the kingdom                                              | Those martyred under the beast, and the rest of the tribulation dead who believed             | Rev 20:4–6; Ch. 15, 17                           |
| <b>The unsaved dead</b>          | After the thousand years                                                       | Every unbeliever of every age, for the great white throne                                     | Rev 20:5, 12–13; Jn 5:29; Dan 12:2; Ch. 19       |



**Figure 7.** The resurrections in order. The first resurrection is completed at the return; the second comes a thousand years later, for judgment.

## Views of the Rapture

| View                                | What it holds                                                                                                        | Where this book answers it                                                              |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pretribulational (this book)</b> | The church is caught up before Daniel’s seventieth week begins; imminent, with no sign required                      | Chapter 3, “The Case in Full: Ten Lines of Evidence”                                    |
| <b>Midtribulational</b>             | The church is caught up at the midpoint, before the great tribulation, often at the seventh trumpet                  | Chapter 3, “The Other Views of the Rapture”                                             |
| <b>Pre-wrath</b>                    | The church endures the first part of the tribulation and is removed before the bowls, when God’s wrath proper begins | Chapter 3, “The Other Views of the Rapture”; Chapter 8 on the seals as the Lamb’s wrath |
| <b>Posttribulational</b>            | The church is caught up at the return and comes straight back down with Christ; one event, not two                   | Chapter 3, “The Rapture and the Second Coming Side by Side”; Chapter 15                 |
| <b>Partial rapture</b>              | Only watchful or faithful believers are taken; the rest go through the tribulation                                   | Chapter 3; Chapter 22 on salvation as a gift, not a reward                              |

## Views of the Millennium

| View                             | What it holds                                                                                                                                               | Where this book answers it                                                                  |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Premillennial (this book)</b> | Christ returns bodily before a literal thousand-year reign on this earth, with Israel restored                                                              | Chapter 17; Chapter 15                                                                      |
| <b>Amillennial</b>               | There is no future earthly kingdom; the thousand years are the present church age, Satan bound at the cross, the promises to Israel fulfilled in the church | Chapter 17, “The Other Views”; Chapter 2 on Israel; Appendix B                              |
| <b>Postmillennial</b>            | The gospel gradually Christianizes the world, producing a golden age, after which Christ returns                                                            | Chapter 17, “The Other Views”; Chapter 5 on the last days as days of apostasy, not progress |

## The Seven Blessings of Revelation

*Seven times Revelation pronounces a blessing. Read together they are the book's own summary of what it asks of its reader: read it, keep it, watch, die in the Lord if it comes to that, and come to the supper.*

|   | Text      | The blessing                                                                                                                    | What it asks                 |
|---|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1 | Rev 1:3   | "Blessed is he that readeth, and they that hear the words of this prophecy, and keep those things which are written therein..." | Read and keep it             |
| 2 | Rev 14:13 | "...Blessed are the dead which die in the Lord from henceforth..."                                                              | Die in the Lord              |
| 3 | Rev 16:15 | "...Blessed is he that watcheth, and keepeth his garments..."                                                                   | Watch                        |
| 4 | Rev 19:9  | "...Blessed are they which are called unto the marriage supper of the Lamb..."                                                  | Come to the supper           |
| 5 | Rev 20:6  | "Blessed and holy is he that hath part in the first resurrection..."                                                            | Share the first resurrection |
| 6 | Rev 22:7  | "...blessed is he that keepeth the sayings of the prophecy of this book"                                                        | Keep the sayings             |
| 7 | Rev 22:14 | "Blessed are they that do his commandments, that they may have right to the tree of life..."                                    | Do His commandments          |

## Schools of Interpretation

| School                      | What it holds                                                                                    | Where this book answers it                            |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Futurist (this book)</b> | Revelation 4–22 describes events still future, to be read as literally as the rest of Scripture  | Prologue, "How This Book Reads Scripture"; Appendix B |
| <b>Preterist</b>            | Most or all of Revelation was fulfilled in the first century, chiefly in A.D. 70                 | Appendix B, "When Revelation Was Written"; Chapter 17 |
| <b>Historicist</b>          | Revelation charts the whole course of church history from John's day to the end                  | Appendix B; the failed date-setting of Chapter 5      |
| <b>Idealist</b>             | Revelation is a timeless picture of the conflict between good and evil, not a sequence of events | Prologue; Appendix B                                  |